

Periodic Assessment — CA-1

Class 5 · CBSE / NCERT · 2026-27

Class:	5	Subject:	EVS
Max Marks:	70	Duration:	2 Hr 30 Min
Name:	_____	Roll No:	_____
Date:	_____	Difficulty:	Hard

Syllabus: Units 1-3 — Water: The Essence of Life, Journey of a River, The Mystery of Food, Our School: A Happy Place, Our Vibrant Country, Some Unique Places

ANSWER KEY

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1 Mark each)

1. Which of the following best explains why sea water cannot be directly used for drinking or irrigation? (1 Mark)

A. It is too cold	B. It contains a high amount of dissolved salt harmful in large quantities ✓
C. It has no water cycle	D. It never evaporates

2. A river system's "catchment area" refers to _____. (1 Mark)

A. the sea it flows into	B. the entire land area from which rain and streams drain into the river ✓
C. a bridge built over the river	D. the delta only

3. Which combination of nutrients would be most useful to recommend to someone recovering from illness and needing to rebuild strength? (1 Mark)

A. Only sugar and fried food	B. Proteins along with vitamins and minerals ✓
C. Only carbonated drinks	D. Only spices

4. Food poisoning most commonly occurs due to _____. (1 Mark)

A. eating fresh fruit	B. consuming contaminated or improperly stored food ✓
C. drinking boiled water	D. eating a balanced diet

5. A school council or student committee mainly helps a school function well by _____. (1 Mark)

A. increasing homework	B. giving students a voice in decisions and encouraging responsibility ✓
C. reducing the number of classes	D. replacing teachers

6. The phrase "unity in diversity" is best challenged (tested) when _____. (1 Mark)

A. people celebrate each other's festivals	B. people from different communities refuse to cooperate or respect each other ✓
C. different languages are spoken in different states	D. India has many geographic regions

7. UNESCO World Heritage Sites in India, such as certain forts and temples, are recognised mainly for _____. (1 Mark)

A. being the tallest buildings	B. their outstanding cultural or natural importance to humanity ✓
C. being the newest constructions	D. having the most visitors only

8. Which of these human activities is most directly responsible for a river drying up or shrinking over time? (1 Mark)

A. Planting trees near the riverbank	B. Excessive damming and over-extraction of water for irrigation and industry ✓
C. Allowing natural rainfall to fill it	D. Protecting its catchment forests

9. Which statement best describes why conserving both water and monuments matters for future generations? (1 Mark)

A. Neither will ever run out or get damaged	B. Both are limited resources/heritage that, once lost or destroyed, are very hard or impossible to fully recover ✓
C. Only water needs to be conserved	D. Only monuments need protection

SECTION B — Short Answer Questions (2 Marks each)

1. Explain why desalination (removing salt from sea water) is not yet a common solution to water shortage everywhere. (2 Marks)

➤ Desalination requires expensive equipment and a lot of energy to remove salt from sea water, so it is costly and not practical for every place, especially areas without enough resources.

2. Why can a river that looks clean at its source become polluted by the time it reaches a big city? (2 Marks)

➤ As the river flows through towns and cities, factories, farms and homes release waste, chemicals and sewage into it, which gradually makes the once-clean water dirty and unsafe.

3. Explain how food habits passed down in a family can affect a child's long-term health. (2 Marks)

➤ If a family regularly eats balanced, home-cooked meals, children learn healthy habits that protect them for life, whereas a family that eats mostly junk food can pass on unhealthy habits leading to future health problems.

4. Discuss briefly why "best before" or expiry dates on packaged food are important to check. (2 Marks)

➤ Food after its expiry date may have lost nutrients or developed harmful bacteria, so checking the date helps avoid eating spoiled food that could make us sick.

5. Explain how a school's environment can influence a student's confidence and behaviour outside school. (2 Marks)
- A school that encourages respect, cooperation and fair treatment builds a student's confidence and teaches good behaviour, which the student then carries into their interactions with family and society outside school.
6. Why might preserving regional languages be considered as important as having one common national language? (2 Marks)
- Regional languages carry unique literature, history and culture of different communities, so protecting them preserves India's diversity, even while a common language helps people from different regions communicate with each other.
7. Explain how tourism at a unique place can be both helpful and harmful to that place. (2 Marks)
- Tourism brings income and awareness about a place's beauty or history, which is helpful, but too many visitors without proper care can cause littering, overcrowding and damage to monuments or nature, which is harmful.
8. How does the loss of forests along a river's path affect the river's health? (2 Marks)
- Forests help hold soil in place and allow rainwater to soak into the ground slowly; when forests are cut down, soil washes into the river causing pollution, and less water reaches the river steadily, sometimes leading to floods or reduced flow.
9. Explain the difference between "food scarcity" and "food wastage" and how both are connected. (2 Marks)
- Food scarcity means not having enough food to eat, while food wastage means good food being thrown away unused; the two are connected because reducing wastage could help provide more food for people who face scarcity.
10. Why is it important for a country as large and diverse as India to have a strong sense of national identity? (2 Marks)
- With so many languages, religions and regions, a strong national identity helps people feel connected as one country, encouraging cooperation and preventing conflicts based on regional or cultural differences.
11. Explain why heritage sites are sometimes damaged even after being legally protected. (2 Marks)
- Heritage sites can be damaged due to pollution, weathering, careless tourists, or lack of enough funds and staff for proper maintenance, even though laws exist to protect them.
12. How can the water cycle be affected by climate change, based on what you have learnt? (2 Marks)
- Climate change can cause unusual patterns of evaporation and rainfall, leading to unexpected droughts in some areas and heavy floods in others, disturbing the normal balance of the water cycle.
13. Explain why students should be involved in keeping their school clean rather than leaving it only to the cleaning staff. (2 Marks)
- When students help keep the school clean, they develop a sense of responsibility and ownership towards their surroundings, and it also reduces the burden on the cleaning staff while teaching a valuable life habit.
14. Why might two rivers in different parts of India, such as one in the north and one in the south, look and behave very differently? (2 Marks)
- Rivers are shaped by the region's climate, land shape and rainfall pattern; a northern river fed by melting snow behaves differently from a southern river that depends mainly on monsoon rains, giving each its own character.

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (Explain) (3 Marks each)

1. Analyse why water, although covering most of the Earth's surface, is still considered a scarce resource in many parts of the world. (3 Marks)
- Most of Earth's water is salty ocean water, which is not directly usable for drinking or farming.
 - Of the small amount of fresh water available, much is locked in glaciers and polar ice, leaving only a small portion easily accessible in rivers, lakes and groundwater.
 - Combined with pollution, wastage and growing population needs, this makes usable fresh water scarce despite water covering most of the planet.
2. Discuss how human settlements along a river's path can both benefit from and negatively affect the river. (3 Marks)
- Settlements benefit from the river through drinking water, irrigation for crops, transport and fishing, which is why many cities have historically grown along riverbanks.
 - However, the same settlements can negatively affect the river by dumping waste, building dams that block natural flow, and over-extracting water for their growing needs.
 - This shows a two-way relationship where careful management is needed to keep the benefit without causing lasting harm.
3. Evaluate why nutritional deficiencies can still occur even in families that regularly eat three meals a day. (3 Marks)
- Eating three meals a day does not guarantee good nutrition if those meals lack variety, for example if they mostly contain carbohydrates but very little protein, vitamins or minerals.
 - Financial limitations, lack of awareness about balanced diets, or preference for cheap processed food can all lead to deficiencies despite regular eating.
 - This shows that the quality and variety of food matters just as much as the quantity or regularity of meals.
4. Discuss how the values learnt in a school environment (cooperation, discipline, respect for diversity) prepare students to be responsible citizens later in life. (3 Marks)
- Schools are often a child's first experience of working with people from different backgrounds, which teaches early lessons in respect and cooperation.
 - Following school rules and taking on responsibilities like class duties builds discipline that carries into adult responsibilities such as following laws and working with others.
 - These small daily lessons in school gradually shape the habits and attitudes needed to be a thoughtful, responsible member of society.
5. Critically discuss whether preserving every old monument in India is realistic, considering the country's resources and needs. (3 Marks)
- India has thousands of heritage sites, and preserving every single one perfectly would require enormous funding, trained experts and continuous maintenance, which is difficult with limited resources.
 - At the same time, some monuments hold especially high historical, cultural or architectural value and deserve priority in conservation efforts.
 - A realistic approach may involve prioritising the most significant sites while encouraging local communities and tourism to support the upkeep of others.
6. Explain how a lack of clean water, poor nutrition and unhygienic surroundings can together affect a community's overall health, using the topics you have studied. (3 Marks)
- Unclean water can spread water-borne diseases, while poor nutrition weakens the body's ability to fight infections, making people more likely to fall ill.
 - Unhygienic surroundings, such as a dirty school or neighbourhood, add to the spread of germs, compounding the problem.
 - Together, these three factors show how water, food and cleanliness are all connected and equally important for a community's wellbeing, not separate, unrelated topics.

SECTION D — Long Answer / Descriptive Questions (5 Marks each)

1. India has great rivers, unique natural and man-made places, and immense cultural diversity. Discuss how these three aspects together shape India's identity, and explain the responsibility citizens have in protecting them. (5 Marks)

- India's rivers, such as the Ganga and Brahmaputra, have supported civilisations, agriculture and trade for thousands of years, making them central to the country's history and economy.
- Unique places like deserts, backwaters, hill stations and monuments showcase both the natural variety of India's geography and the skill of its people across centuries.
- Cultural diversity in languages, festivals and traditions adds richness, making India a country where many identities exist together as one nation.
- Citizens have a responsibility to protect these resources and places by avoiding pollution, respecting heritage sites, and valuing the diversity around them, ensuring that future generations can experience the same richness.

2. Explain the full connection between the water cycle, balanced nutrition and human wellbeing, showing how disturbing one part of this system can affect the others. (5 Marks)

- The water cycle provides fresh water needed to grow crops, which are a major source of the carbohydrates, proteins, vitamins and minerals found in a balanced diet.
- If the water cycle is disturbed by deforestation, pollution or climate change, rainfall patterns can change, leading to poor harvests and food shortages.
- This, in turn, can cause malnutrition in communities that depend on those crops, showing that water, food and health are deeply interconnected.
- Protecting water sources and forests is therefore not just an environmental issue but also directly linked to ensuring people get proper nutrition and stay healthy.

3. Imagine you are asked to design a short awareness campaign for your school on "protecting our water, food and heritage." Describe three key messages you would include and explain why each is important. (5 Marks)

- First message: "Do not waste water" - because fresh water is limited and needed by everyone, wasting it affects future availability for all.
- Second message: "Eat balanced and avoid wasting food" - because good nutrition keeps us healthy, and wasting food is unfair when many people do not get enough to eat.
- Third message: "Respect and protect historical places" - because monuments and heritage sites cannot be replaced once damaged, and they connect us to our country's history.
- Together, these messages remind students that small daily actions add up to protecting resources and places that benefit everyone, now and in the future.